

1946, March 4

The following is the faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. MICHAEL'S CHURCH

225 JEROME STREET

BROOKLYN 7, N.Y.

March 4th 1946

v. Sister Mary Rose Francis, S.S.J.

St. Gertrude Convent, St. Clair Shores, Michigan.

Dear Sister Mary Rose Frances:

God bless you and yours.

Only Today did I come to your favor of February 24th and though several times interrupted have just finished it. I hardly know what to advise you, other than that you simply practice patience with yourself as well as with your neighbor - whether in the classroom or in the Convent or elsewhere. For we may be sure that we come nowhere in the practice of virtue or in spiritual progress with patiently humbling ourselves in the face of the difficulties where-with the divinely jealous Lover of our poor souls is pleased to cheque our selfconceit and pride.

If the Dear Lord has deigned to invite you to more than ordinary virtue and if on your part you have, perhaps again and again, seen something of the privilege of such an invitation, - finally concentrating even half generously to follow the CRUCIFIED SPOUSE, then you may quite naturally - logically rather - expect difficulties of some kind or of any kind to exercise you in the virtues that put the enemies the Cross to shame and make Heaven rejoice. Such virtues are ofcourse first of all Humility from which all other virtues worth while in God's sight, take root and nourishment.

I am inclosing a letter, written several years ago by the present Rt. Rev. Edw'd F. Casey, who was rescued from a Jap prison a year ago - Febr. 23rd 1945. I am quite sure you will proffit in its earnest perusal and study.

At all events and whatever comes turn frequently to our dear Lord in the Tabernacle and next Him, to our Blessed Mother Mary, begging for the grace to correspond to the graces that He is always lavishing on our unworthy selves and for patience and HUMILITY.